



STUDENT GUIDE & WORKBOOK MODULE 2: TOPIC 3

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TOPIC 3

LEADERSHIP AND INNOVATION

"Innovation distinguishes between a leader and a follower"

-Steve Jobs

I. Activity - Spaghetti Marshmallow Challenge

CHALLENGING THE PROCESS WITH THE MARSHMALLOW CHALLENGE

Jody Rogers

Purpose

An extremely fun and educational way to reinforce key concepts of the practice, Challenge the Process. This is an easy activity that requires minimal space and very few supplies to perform.

Group Size

No more than 5 people per team. If the total group size is just 5 or 6 people, divide the group into teams of 3, if possible. Team size is more important than total number of participants involved in the activity.

Time Required

45 minutes or less

5-minute introduction; 18-minute activity; 5-minute video. Additional time for discussion. The 18-minute exercise is fixed. Other times can be adjusted as needed.

Materials

Each team needs 1 yard of tape, 1 yard of string, 20 pieces of spaghetti (uncooked, of course), and one marshmallow. I also recommend making available one or two small scissors for all teams in the group to access during the activity.

Instructions

1. Divide attendees into teams of 3-5 members
2. Give each team the tape, string, spaghetti, and marshmallow. Supply each team access to scissors (it isn't necessary for each team to have its own)
3. Read the following instructions to all teams at the same time
4. Each team has 18 minutes to build the tallest, free-standing structure using the materials supplied to each group. The marshmallow must be attached to the top of the structure you build. After 18 minutes, I will measure the height of each structure that remains standing with the marshmallow on top. The winner is the team whose free-standing structure is the tallest
5. Answer any questions the teams may have and give the groups a 30 second warning. After 30 seconds, start the activity and stand back. Keep watch on the teams to ensure they are following the rules of the game. Remind them that the marshmallow must be on the top of the structure, and that the structure itself must be free-standing when the activity concludes. Let them know how much time has passed until 18 minutes is up
6. At the end of 18 minutes, measure those structures created within the rules and that are still standing
7. After declaring the winner (assuming there is a structure that remains standing after the marshmallow has been attached), show the participants the YouTube video clip of The Marshmallow Challenge

Follow-up questions to ask of the group to facilitate discussion and further learning:

1. Was there a leader on your team? Who was it and who decided who the leader would be?
2. If you had no leader, do you think having designated someone a leader would have helped?
3. If you had a leader, how did they do? Of the leadership practices we have learned so far, which did your leader use?
4. How helpful was everyone on your team in challenging the process of building the tallest structure? Did anyone appear to be an expert?
5. Did any team members tune out of the activity — out of frustration with other members or for some other reason? What could you have done to keep all members of the group fully engaged?
6. Did you feel everyone's ideas were well received during the activity?
7. How did you feel as the time limit was approaching? Did pressure increase? If yes, was that helpful or not?
8. In retrospect, what could you have done better to enhance your ability to Challenge the Process?

9. Did you practise oversight? Where might new ideas have come from given your time constraint?
10. Did you celebrate small wins? If yes, how did you do this?
11. Encourage the Heart of all participants by giving everyone the marshmallows remaining in the bag. Everyone loves marshmallows!

2. Group Activity – What is Leadership?

In groups of 2-3 discuss the following:

1. What do you think Leadership is? (give examples)
2. Make a list of at least 6 traits you think a good leader should have
3. Is there a difference between a Leader and a Manager? If yes, what is the difference?

In your same groups, watch the below TedTalk and then review your answers to the questions above and note down any changes.

TedTalk

Hamza Khan – TEDxRyersonU / August, 2016

Stop Managing, Start Leading

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=d_HHnEROy_w

3. Activity – Read the following article on Leadership Styles

<https://www.skillsyouneed.com/leadership-skills.html>

LEADERSHIP STYLES

There are many different models of leadership styles, from those that look at how much 'control' you want to others based around 'potential'.

One of the best-known models is Daniel Goleman's Six Leadership Styles. Goleman is probably best known for his work on Emotional Intelligence, but he also carried out a ground-breaking study on leadership, published in the Harvard Business Review in 2000 as 'Leadership that Gets Results'.

Based on a three-year study of over 3,000 executives, Daniel Goleman identified six different leadership styles.

6 Leadership Styles

1. Coercive

Coercive leaders *demand immediate obedience.*

In a single phrase, this style is ‘Do what I tell you’.

These leaders show initiative, self-control, and drive to succeed. There is, of course, a time and a place for such leadership: a battlefield is the classic example, but any crisis will need clear, calm, commanding leadership. This style does not, however, encourage anyone else to take the initiative, and often has a negative effect on how people feel.

2. Pace-setting

Pace-setting leaders *expect excellence and self-direction.*

This style can be summed up as ‘Do as I do, now’.

The Pace-setter very much leads by example, but this type of leadership only works with a highly-competent and well-motivated team. It can only be sustained for a while without team members flagging. Like the Coercive leader, Pacesetters also show drive to succeed and initiative, but instead of self-control, these are coupled with conscientiousness.

3. Authoritative

Authoritative leaders *move people towards a vision.*

This style is probably best summed up as ‘Come with me’.

These leaders are visionary and it's the most useful style when a new vision or clear direction is needed and is most strongly positive. Authoritative leaders are high in self-confidence and empathy, acting as a change catalyst by drawing people into the vision and engaging them with the future.

4. Affiliative

An Affiliative leader *values and creates emotional bonds and harmony.*

Affiliative leaders believe that ‘People come first’.

Such leaders demonstrate empathy, and strong communication skills, and are very good at building relationships. This style is most useful when a team has been through a difficult experience, and needs to heal rifts, or develop motivation. It is not a very goal-oriented style, so anyone using it will need to make sure others understand that the goal is team harmony, and not specific tasks.

It is probably obvious from this that it cannot be used on its own for any length of time if you need to ‘get the job done’.

5. Democratic

Democratic leaders *build consensus through participation.*

Democratic leaders are constantly asking ‘What do you think?’.

Such leaders show high levels of collaboration, team leadership and strong communication skills. This style of leadership works well in developing ownership for a project, but it can make for slow progress towards goals, until a certain amount of momentum has built up. Anyone wishing to use this style will need to make sure that senior managers are signed up to the process and understand that it may take time to develop the consensus.

6. Coaching

Coaching leaders *develop people.*

The phrase that sums up this leadership style is ‘Try it’

Coaching leaders allow people to try different approaches to problem solving and achieving a goal in an open way. The coaching leader shows high levels of empathy, self-awareness and skills in developing others. A coaching style is especially useful when an organisation values long-term staff development.

4. Activity – Women and Leadership (Ted Talk)

Ted Talk

Sheryl Sandberg – COO Facebook / TEDWomen December 2010

Why we have too few women leaders

https://www.ted.com/talks/sheryl_sandberg_why_we_have_too_few_women_leaders

As the COO at the helm of Facebook, Sheryl Sandberg juggles the tasks of monetising the world’s largest social networking site and keeping its users happy and engaged.

Sheryl’s talk looks at why a smaller percentage of women than men reach the top of their professions and offers 3 powerful pieces of advice to women aiming for the corporate suite.

Listen to Sheryl Sandberg’s Ted Talk and discuss the following questions:

1. What is the name of Sheryl’s book?
2. Why weren’t women speaking as much in class?
3. What is ‘cold calling’?
4. What stereotypes is Sheryl speaking of?

- 
5. Why is 'bossy' different for men and women?
 6. What does 'left over' mean in China?
 7. What is the difference in payment in the US for men and women who are White, Black and Latino?

DEVELOPING AN INNOVATIVE TEAM

A group of people doing the same or similar work does not make a team. A group of people who are working to achieve the same goal does not make a team. It is possible for people in a group to do their work without really interacting with the others.

What makes a group of people work as a team starts with the recognition that, through working together, they can obtain a higher level of success than that which can be obtained by simply adding individual efforts.

Below are points to consider when identifying a team:

- The skills and knowledge of each member
- Diversity in the team
- Members with team skills
- Members must be analytical enough
- True commitment, not just "lips service"

What is Innovation?

Innovation is a process by which an idea or invention is translated into a good or service for which people will pay. To be called an innovation, an idea must be replicable at an economical cost and must satisfy a specific need. (IBSA 2010).

Innovation is a term that is often used interchangeably with things like continuous improvement, creativity or just thinking differently. Innovations can take place in strategy, services, processes and culture and can be divided into two broad categories:

1. Incremental Improvements – those that relate to improving today's business
2. Strategic Concept Innovations – those that will create tomorrow's business

Types of Innovation

Evolution versus Revolution – Innovation can be incremental, life altering or somewhere in between. Some innovations have resulted in huge changes to the way we live and think. For example:

- The automobile
- The internet
- The emergence of China
- The computer
- Modern medicine
- Nuclear energy

These innovations could be regarded as revolutionary.

The innovations below are less life altering yet still involve changes that make a difference in our lives. They often involve altering a product or process. These could include such things as:

- The paper clip
- The optical mouse
- The frozen pizza

Different types of workplace innovations include:

- Product
- Process
- Organisational
- Marketing
- Strategic
- Technological

5. Activity – Innovation is not efficient

Motivational speaker, Simon Sinek, states that *“innovation is not efficient.”*

Do you agree or disagree with this statement?

Watch the below YouTube video and discuss opinions as a class:

YouTube – Simon Sinek

Simon Sinek / August, 2016

Innovation is not Efficient

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9ATh-qIxzZM>

6. Activity – Revolutionary Innovations

1. In groups of three, identify three Revolutionary Innovations, and three Evolutionary Innovations
2. In your teams, identify at least one example of each of the examples of innovations listed below

Examples of Innovations

Innovation Type	Description	Example
Product	The introduction of a good or service that is new or significantly improved	Microwave oven
Process	The implementation of a new or significantly improved production or delivery method. This includes significant changes in techniques, equipment or software	Vendor managed inventory
Organisational	The implementation of a new organisational method in the firm's business practices, workplace or external relations	Allow customers to purchase goods and services via the Internet. E.g. online shopping
Marketing	An incremental improved change to the product design or offers, packaging, positioning, promotions, distribution or pricing.	The inclusion of air bags in motor vehicles, or the green revolution, manufacturing companies using re-usable packaging.



Fostering Innovation and Change

To get ideas generated and change encouraged, successful organisations need to look at the following factors:

1. **Develop an Acceptance of Change.** This will only happen if the employees and managers are all involved in making the decisions of change. This leads to better buy-in by all and enables employees to see the advantages and disadvantages of any change, individually and collectively. They can then measure its consequences
2. **Encourage New Ideas.** The management from top down must make it clear they welcome new ideas. Some companies establish communication teams to encourage, assess and reward new ideas
3. **Permit Interaction.** Interaction between different work groups and levels within the firm will allow for the free exchange of information, the flow of ideas and new perspectives on old problems
4. **Tolerating Failure.** Many new ideas may not work, but if we don't try we never know. Our competitors will test and perhaps prove a new idea first and we will fall behind
5. **Clear Goals and Objectives.** All employees must be informed of the goals and objectives of the organisation, so that everyone is heading in the same direction
6. **Offering Recognition.** The right staff members must be recognised for the new idea and jobs well done. Where someone is given credit for work that is not theirs, this will stop the flow of ideas and cause conflict

HOW TO DEVELOP A CULTURE OF INNOVATION

Article By George Pyne

In today's world, companies can no longer rely solely on brand loyalty to sell products and services. Today, with sophisticated consumers bombarded by a myriad of choices and informed by social media and other digital platforms, business success requires extreme innovation.

Innovation doesn't happen just by luck or chance. It takes work. To that end, business leaders must create a passionate culture of innovation that provides employees with the necessary tools to develop concrete plans and measurable results.

Ideas Are the Most Powerful Tools in Business

As a business leader, you are responsible for creating a culture that continually generates ideas and inspires innovation: build the right team, encourage your employees to recognise and seize opportunities, avoid complacency and demonstrate confidence in their follow-through.

When I was at NASCAR, management teams were able to detect trends, both up and down, through bi-weekly financial and progress review sessions. They could react quickly to change.

Through this process at NASCAR, we discovered unmet needs in the marketplace. Rather than continuing to operate within the existing status quo, we executed a fundamental sea change, transforming the business from a regional sports platform into a national sport.

The transformation was validated when 100 of the Fortune 500 companies invested in the sport with billions of sponsorship dollars that were invested in media and sponsorship rights. NASCAR became the #1 in spectator attendance and #2 in television viewership.

Innovation Can Be Simple

Sometimes, being innovative is not about doing something enormous. Many of the greatest innovations lie in simple ideas — ones that make something work so easily, that it becomes a seamless part of our world. Jack Dorsey, Twitter's founder, told Charlie Rose in an interview: "I think the best technologies — and Twitter is included in this — disappear. They fade into the background, and they're relevant when you want to use them, and they get out of the way when you don't."



Twitter's stunning simplicity is what has made it such a blockbuster. That less-is-more approach — creating something that stealthily becomes a part of our lives — is true innovation. The simplest things are often the hardest to master.

The same is true with LinkedIn, founded by “start-up sleeper” Reid Hoffman. His company has virtually obliterated the need for a paper resume, making career advancement a process, woven into social media.

The latest example of LinkedIn's innovation is its brand-new standalone iOS app, called “LinkedIn Contacts,” which aggregates all your business contacts in one place. This is another example of a simple idea, executed brilliantly — your most important business contacts can be easily and quickly accessed.

The best business leaders innovate before they are forced to. Jeff Bezos, CEO of Amazon, put it best in his 2012 letter to shareholders. “When we're at our best, we don't wait for external pressures. We are *internally* driven to improve our services, adding benefits and features, before we have to,” he wrote. “We lower prices and increase value for customers before we have to. We invent before we have to.”

There Is No Substitute for Passion and Integrity

Taking an idea from concept to market is hard work. In the end, the only thing that sustains a business during the inevitable ups and downs of economic cycles is passion for the idea. When the people working on the idea are passionate and have integrity, the innovation intrinsically has those same qualities. This keeps the business moving forward.

Innovation is cultural. It starts with ideation, followed by a plan to be executed, which is measured for results.

For me, innovation is achieved through a culture of ideas, a system of planning and great communication.

George Pyne is president of IMG Sports and Entertainment, IMG board member and board member of 24-Hour Fitness. He is also the former chief operating officer and a board member of NASCAR.

WHAT DOES INNOVATION MEAN TO YOU?

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